

Growing Together — Module 01: Systems — Think About It

Part A: Family Discussion Questions

1. Who is in your family system? (Do not forget pets or people who live far away!).
2. What is the "Goal" of your family? (To be happy? To be safe? To learn?).
3. If your family was a machine, what kind would it be? (A fast car? A cozy spaceship?).
4. What happens to the system when someone is sick?
5. What are the "Rules" that keep your system running smoothly? (No hitting, Wash hands).
6. How do you bring energy INTO the family? (Hugs, jokes, yummy food).
7. What drains energy FROM the family? (Fighting, too much TV, rushing).
8. Is your room a "Sub-System" inside the house? (Yes, you control it!).
9. How does your family connect to other systems? (School, Church, Sports Teams).
10. Why is it better to be a system (a team) than to be all alone?

Part B: Hands-On Activities and Reflection

1. Draw a picture of your family as a system. Put each person in a circle and draw lines between people who help each other. How many connections did you find?
2. Sit in a circle and hold hands. Have one person squeeze gently. Pass the squeeze around. How fast does the signal travel through your system?
3. Pick one family routine (like bedtime or dinner). Together, list every step. How many steps does it take to keep the system running?
4. What is one thing that happened this week that changed the whole family's mood? Draw or write about how the change rippled through the system.
5. Walk through your house together. What are the "boundaries" of your family system? (The front door? The yard fence?). What comes in and what stays out?
6. Make a list of the "inputs" your family needs every day (food, love, sleep, fun). What happens if one input is missing?

7. Together as a family, build a tower of blocks or cups. Take one piece away. What happens? This is how systems work — every part matters.
8. Think of a time your family had to change its routine (a move, a new baby, a holiday). How did the system adapt?
9. Create a "Family Energy Meter" on paper. Draw a battery. Together, color in how full the family's energy is today. What could recharge it?
10. Write or draw one thing you are grateful for about your family system. Share it with everyone at the dinner table tonight.